

credibility in your profile you can then start planning your trips. Plan your itinerary and search for members who live within a few (say 20) kilometers or miles along your route. Contact members who you think will make a good fit and explain to them what sort of travel and stay you are interested in. There is a “Request to CouchSurf with...” button that enables you to include specific details. Once you’ve put in the request it is more than likely that you will get lots of offers for places to stay. You can then firm up your finally itinerary, send confirmations to your hosts, and fly off to the starting point of your tour route.

Depending on how you’ve set up with each host, some may even pick you up from the airport and show you around the city. They can invite you to meet friends and have dinner giving you a chance to sample authentic local cuisine. CouchSurfers are most helpful, they will in all likelihood be very hospitable and take you to see all the interesting places in the city or provide you useful tips on how to navigate your way through the city.

There are also some unwritten rules of good couchsurfing. You show your appreciation for your hosts in kind. While the hosts may not ask you to do anything around the house, you could help out by washing the dishes, making them an authentic Indian meal (or at least help out with the recipe if you don’t know how to cook!) or you may be (being a Digit reader!) an IT whiz and help them with some computer glitches.

Once you work through your itinerary and return home, you log into CouchSurfing, leave feedback about your hosts and see the feedback your hosts have left about you! The basic idea is to participate in the community and encourage the spirit of cooperation and sharing. Likewise if people are visiting your city keep a couch ready for them!